retinol. Some carotene may be absorbed intact and later converted to vitamin 'A' in the liver or kidney. Bile is necessary for the absorption of vitamin A and carotene. Vitamin E in the intestinal tract prevents oxidation of the vitamin. Mineral oil hinders absorption since it dissolves the vitamin but is not absorbed.

Food sources



Sources of Vitamin A

Liver, milk, egg – yolk, carrots, dark green leafy vegetables and yellow fruits are high in vitamin A or beta – carotene.

Deficiency

A diet deficient in vitamin A for several months may lead to night blindness and flaking skin.

A long – term vitamin A deficiency leads Xerophthalmia, major symptom of which is dry, hard cornea. If this condition is left untreated, damage to the cornea progresses, leading to a softening of the cornea and eventually total blindness.

Vitamin A deficiency also affects the skin, causing it to become dry and rough.

If xerophthalmia and the underlying vitamin A deficiency are treated at an early stage, blindness can be prevented.

Vitamin D (Calciferol)

The human body can produce vitamin D from cholesterol present in the skin. This conversion depends on exposure of the skin to the ultraviolet rays in sunlight and yields inactive pro-vitamin D. Both inactive vitamin D formed in the skin and vitamin D absorbed from dietary sources are transported through the bloodstream to the liver, where they are stored.

Functions

- Vitamin D helps with the absorption, transport and use of calcium.
- Vitamin D assists in bone growth and the integrity of bone and promotes strong teeth.
- It also helps to regulate the amount of phosphorus in the body as well as assisting in a healthy heart and nervous system.

Food sources



Sources of Vitamin D

Vitamin D is present in fatty fish like kipper, sardines, salmon, tuna and mackerel, liver, egg yolk and butter. Smaller amounts are also present in dark leafy vegetables.

Absorption

Dietary vitamin D is absorbed along with dietary fats in the small intestines and transported to the lymph system. Bile is essential for the absorption of this vitamin Excess vitamin is stored in the body.

DO YOU KNOW?

Which is the only non-animal natural source of vitamin-D – Mushroom. The best source of vittamin D is Sun.

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